

## Face-2-Face with Employer

“We accept people from multidisciplinary backgrounds. Artists, programmers, sound engineers. None have had any formal education in this regard. With no industry relevant courses, the onus strangely lies on the industry itself to train in industry-relevant skills,”

Rajesh Rao  
Founder of Dhruva  
Interactive

- Being a self-starter
- Having an aptitude for quality and detail
- Be committed to meet deadlines and work under minimal guidance
- Intrinsic talent is one of the key thing besides the commitment
- The ability to take constructive criticism can take you far in this profession
- The ability to give feedback without seeming condescending especially when you working in a team
- Exposure to technology and your own desire to learn can get you far in the industry

*Christopher Erdhardt, founder of the Indian School of Gaming* says what the gaming industry needs is “Nerds. No, seriously, math geeks that are fans of games other than *Counter-strike* and *NFS*. Remember that the bulk of games sold in the USA and UK are family-friendly casual games. So someone open to new types of games excels.” Game design is where most gamers would jump for. This requires a far more subtler skill. Rajesh from Dhruva illustrates, “If you’ve played a lot of games from beginning to end, you start understanding the ladder of challenge. You understand the different learning curves for different kinds of games. For instance, as a writer, it helps if you did a lot of reading in your formative years. It works exactly the same way with gaming. You can’t have a guy who has spent years in the creative department of an advertising agency pop-out and say he’ll design a game. This sort of person would stick to a linear form of story telling and gaming has gone beyond this.”

It’s different disciplines. Individual contributor is mainly it for the first couple of years. Then highly specialised contributors then mentors and managers, assistant leaders, project management etc.

## Compensation

Early on, it could be approximately Rs 10,000-15,000. Further, Rs. 20,000- 40,000 or so in 2 years and anywhere between Rs. 40,000 to 50,000 in the fourth year. Rs. 50,000 to 70,000 from 5th year onwards. *Please note: These figures do not represent the compensation package of any one company. It is an approximate based on discussions with experts across companies.*

## Mid-career changes

According to Rao, “Programmers do not exactly change careers after some-time. While we do notice depending on the interest that designers and artists make a switch. Sometimes designers take up arts and the other way around.”

## Institutes offering Animation and Game-related courses:

- Academy Of Animation And Gaming, Noida
- AIGA – Asian Institute Of Gaming And Animation, Bangalore
- Animaster, Bangalore
- Ants Studio Pvt. Ltd., Bangalore
- Aptech Limited (Arena Animation), Mumbai
- Arena Animation, Indore
- Arena Multimedia Park Street, Kolkatta
- Dsk Superinfocom International Campus, Pune
- Frameboxx Animation | Visual Effects, Mumbai
- Gecko Animation Studio, New Delhi